Last Minute Courier

High Concept | v0.8 | November 8, 2026

High concept statement

A campus movie night is missing its coffee, projector lens and final reel. As the last courier on shift, you borrow three seconds from blue-tagged machinery to find safe crossing and boarding windows, deliver all three parcels, and earn a seat at the screening.

Player role and primary gameplay

You control one courier in a connected 3D campus, using an avatar-based interaction model and a dynamic third-person camera. This is a single-player action and timing puzzle game: observe a moving device, choose a path, move or jump through a safe window, and deliver. The camera follows without head bob, shake, motion blur or speed zoom. Mouse control, gentle recentering, optional direction lock, sensitivity and field-of-view controls support different preferences.

Audience

For players who understand a keyboard and mouse but may be new to 3D action games. Three short opening cards (story, ability, key-cap controls) and an untimed practice yard precede the first deadline. Wide paths, nearby recovery points and longer alternative paths support cautious players; lifts, stepping stones and a shuttle offer more demanding routes. English is the default, with Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Spanish, French and German available from a language selector. Translation coverage is checked; native-speaker review is pending.

Distinctive experience

The Borrower slows marked machinery to one quarter speed for up to three seconds, a few times per delivery (3, 4, then 5 uses, counted beside the Q key). It leaves the courier and deadline unchanged, so extending a safe window still costs delivery time. Releasing it after boarding makes transport useful again. One rule supports avoidance, boarding and route planning. Each parcel has its own concern: the coffee cools, the lens case cracks after three knocks, and the reel must beat the screening. Borrower cells on the harder lines give Q extra uses, and each delivery is rated 1-3 stars by its concern, so a finished run is worth replaying.

Each parcel changes the same evening: coffee brings warm cups and a musical layer; the lens prepares the projector and brings an audience; the reel opens the cinema. Three delivery stamps become one admission ticket. The courier contributes to a shared event and receives a place in it.

World and progression

A small, stylized campus connects a parcel desk, coffee plaza, garden, projection booth and clocktower cinema. Cream buildings, terracotta details, blue clock tags and orange route markers make roles recognizable. Read the story, practice movement/jumping/time control, then complete coffee, lens and reel orders in sequence. Read each untimed brief before accepting its deadline. A collision or fall returns to a nearby checkpoint; an order retry preserves earlier deliveries. Completion reveals the screening and offers Play Again.

Modes, platform and scope

One local single-player campaign; no multiplayer, competitive mode or separate time-trial mode. Timed delivery is the primary gameplay mode; untimed practice and collection are preparation modes. Story, briefing, pause/help, results, timeout and completion are shell screens. Target releases are Windows x86-family, macOS and Linux x86-family; exact Windows/Linux bitness must be confirmed if the instructor means 32-bit specifically. Mac is the current development and validation platform.

One complete level is implemented. The target first completed run is 5-10 minutes without filler. A real-speed autoplay using only player controls reached the ending in 3:00 from the first story card (Nov 7, v0.5.4). It already knows every route, so this is an expert lower bound and does not establish first-time player duration. Genuine first-time timing, learning transfer, enjoyment and comfort remain acceptance checks.

Course structure checked against lecture deck 3, slides 19-23, 35, 47, 55 and 80-82. Monetary and licensed-IP pitches are omitted as permitted for this class. No minimum hardware specification is claimed without independent build tests.